



ICS Journalism Club Interviews Karşıyaka Residents

As the ICS Journalism Club, under the supervision of our club advisor Fatih Selçuk, we conducted interviews with local residents in Karşıyaka on a variety of topics. While the people of Karşıyaka answered our questions about art, culture, and sports, the Journalism Club students themselves gained valuable experience in their field. Our interviews will continue in different locations in the coming period. Don't forget to follow our newspaper.

Izmir's Scorching Heat and Passion for Sports

On a scorching morning in Izmir, a team sought refuge at Starbucks before heading out to interview locals about their interest in sports. They encountered a range of responses, from a Trabzon-born woman proudly supporting Trabzonspor despite not following sports, to a young athlete who plays volleyball and basketball. A kind professor offered them refreshments, and by the waterfront, an older man enthusiastically shared his love for swimming and football. As they wrapped up their day, a sudden downpour mirrored the city's vibrant unpredictability—highlighting how diverse and refreshing people's passions can be.

More about this on page 2.

Perceptions of Book Fairs in Karşıyaka and Bostanlı: A Re- flection of Personal Traits

This piece examines public perceptions of book fairs in Karşıyaka and Bostanlı, highlighting how personal traits and language skills shape engagement with cultural events. During a walk between the districts on April 27th, the author interviewed locals about the upcoming Alsancak Book Fair. English-speaking participants—more common in Bostanlı—showed greater interest in reading and culture. Interviewees' interests ranged from fantasy to philosophy, suggesting a connection between language proficiency, cultural participation, and district demographics.

More about this on pages 2 & 3.

Football Allegiance and Exercise Habits in Karşıyaka: In- sights from a Neigh- borhood Survey

In Karşıyaka, İzmir, a field study led by Professor Fatih revealed strong local support for Galatasaray, with minimal backing for Beşiktaş and none for Fenerbahçe. Residents cited weak player quality, poor transfer policies, and team disunity as reasons for Fenerbahçe's long title drought. The study also found that most locals engage in basic physical activity, primarily walking and running, highlighting the intersection of sports loyalty and everyday health habits in the community.

More about this on page 3.



Izmir's Scorching Heat and Passion for Sports

by **Bora Yağız (8A)**



One morning in Izmir, even the first rays of the sun couldn't spare us from its oppressive heat... While cooling off at Starbucks with my team, we turned our interview route toward the public. Our first stop was with a Trabzon-born lady in Karşıyaka Bazaar. When I asked, *"What sports are you interested in?"* she replied coolly, *"I'm not into sports."* Yet, when I followed up with, *"Which team do you support?"* she proudly declared, *"Trabzonspor!"*

Next, I spoke with the daughter of a hearing-impaired gentleman. When I posed the same questions, her answer was entirely different: *"I play sports—volleyball, and a bit of basketball."* Once again, the diversity of people's perspectives was starkly evident.

Parched from the heat, we were relieved when Professor Fatih treated us to water and refreshing Petitoss. Re-energized, we headed to the waterfront. There, we met a man in his sixties who, with childlike enthusiasm, told us about his sports passions: *"Swimming and football."*

After wrapping up the interviews, we set off for Latife Hanım Mansion. En route, the sky suddenly turned black with clouds and burst into a heavy downpour. Fortunately, the mansion was closed, so we enjoyed the rain's spectacle from under cover. In Izmir, talking sports is as unpredictable and colorful as the city's changing weather... and people's passions refresh our spirits like a cool rain after a hot morning.

Perceptions of Book Fairs in Karşıyaka and Bostanlı: A Reflection of Personal Traits

by **Meiling Kamilova (10A)**

On April 27th, I met with Mr. Fatih in Karşıyaka to explore public perceptions of book fairs, focusing on the ongoing Alsancak Book Fair. Book fairs are more than just cultural events—they can reveal personal reading habits, interests, and even social characteristics. I aimed to understand how views on book fairs differ between Karşıyaka and Bostanlı, two neighboring districts with distinct demographics.

As we walked from Karşıyaka to Bostanlı, I noticed that finding English-speaking interviewees was somewhat difficult, especially in Karşıyaka. Despite the language barrier, I was able to speak with several individuals willing to share their thoughts.

The first person I interviewed was a man who spoke English fluently. He was aware of the book fair but hadn't visited yet, citing a lack of time. He said he mostly reads fantasy novels.

The second person said he wasn't aware of the book fair. He mentioned that he enjoys reading geology books.





Continued: *Izmir's Scorching Heat and Passion for Sports*

The third individual knew about the fair but hadn't attended yet. He planned to visit the following week. He described himself as an avid reader, particularly fond of romantic literature.

The fourth interviewee, a woman, had already visited the fair and said she greatly enjoyed it. She had purchased many books and said her favorite genre was fiction.

The final person I spoke with had heard about the fair but hadn't been able to attend, as she was not a local resident. She expressed interest in going and said she enjoys reading fiction and sometimes philosophy, depending on her psychological state.

Reflecting on these interviews, a pattern began to emerge: those who spoke English tended to read more regularly and showed greater interest in the book fair. While Karşıyaka has a larger population overall, Bostanlı appeared to have a higher proportion of English-speaking individuals.

Football Allegiance and Exercise Habits in Karşıyaka: Insights from a Neighborhood Survey

by Yağız Erdoğan (6A)

On a warm İzmir morning, we met with Professor Fatih in Karşıyaka. Walking step by step through the neighborhood's lively streets, we conducted face-to-face interviews and tabulated the responses. Examining the table, we observed:

- A significant majority of Karşıyaka residents support Galatasaray.
- A small segment are Beşiktaş fans.
- No one supports Fenerbahçe or declares allegiance to that club.

In the same table, when asked "Why hasn't Fenerbahçe won the league in 11 years?" the main answers were:

- The quality of the players does not meet expectations.
- The club's transfer policies have not been sufficiently successful.
- There is a lack of cohesion within the team.

In another set of questions—"Do you exercise?"—the majority of participants replied:

- "I only do walking and running as my daily exercise."



This field study reveals how football passion in Karşıyaka intertwines with regional distinctions and personal habits. The results show, on one hand, how the neighborhood's identity is closely tied to its sporting culture, and on the other, how individuals' health routines are shaped by limited choices.

İzmir Weather Forecast

Today in İzmir, expect a mild and breezy day with morning clouds giving way to sunshine. Temperatures will reach around **21°C**, with northeast winds blowing at **15–30 km/h**. Rain is unlikely, and the evening will cool down to about **12°C**.



Overview: India-Pakistan Conflict on Kashmir

by *S. Aeera Fetima (7A)*

The Kashmir conflict is a long-standing territorial dispute between India and Pakistan, rooted in the events of 1947, when both countries gained independence from British rule. At the center of the conflict lies the region of Jammu and Kashmir, a princely state at the time of Partition. The Maharaja of Kashmir, Hari Singh, initially sought to remain independent. However, after tribal militias from Pakistan invaded, he acceded to India in exchange for military assistance, leading to the first war between the two nations.

Since then, **India and Pakistan** have fought three wars over Kashmir (in 1947-48, 1965, and 1999), along with several skirmishes and a constant state of tension. The United Nations intervened early on, calling for a ceasefire and proposing a plebiscite, but no such vote has ever taken place due to differing conditions set by both sides.

India controls about two-thirds of the region, which includes Jammu, the Kashmir Valley, and Ladakh, while Pakistan controls the remaining one-third, which it calls Azad Jammu and Kashmir (AJK) and Gilgit-Baltistan. India considers the entire region an integral part of its territory, while Pakistan views it as a disputed land and supports Kashmiri self-determination.

The conflict has been marked by military standoffs, cross-border firing, militant insurgency, and terrorist attacks. In 1989, an armed insurgency began in Indian-administered Kashmir, which India accuses Pakistan of fueling with support for militant groups. Pakistan denies direct involvement, calling it moral and diplomatic support for the Kashmiri people.

In August 2019, India revoked Article 370 of its Constitution, which gave special autonomy to Jammu and Kashmir. This move further escalated tensions with Pakistan, which downgraded diplomatic ties and raised the issue internationally. India asserts this is an internal matter, while Pakistan argues it violates international agreements and the rights of Kashmiris.

Today, Kashmir remains one of the **most militarized zones in the world**, with regular clashes along the Line of Control (LoC) and deep-rooted mistrust between the two nuclear-armed neighbors. The issue remains unresolved, with diplomatic efforts often stalled by political and military flashpoints.

Youth Unemployment in the United States

by *İdil Kalyencioğlu (10A)*

Youth unemployment in the United States has long been a serious economic and social issue. The youth unemployment rate—typically measured among individuals aged 16 to 24—consistently runs higher than that of the adult population.

Causes of Youth Unemployment

There are several root causes behind high youth unemployment. The first is lack of experience. Since most young people are entering the labor force for the first time, they do not yet possess the on-the-job skills employers seek, causing recruiters to favor more experienced candidates. Another key factor is inadequate education. Young people from low-income families often struggle to access high-quality schooling, putting them at a disadvantage in the labor market.



Continued: Youth Unemployment in the United States

Technological transformation is also reshaping youth employment prospects. Advances such as artificial intelligence and digitalization are narrowing traditional job categories while elevating roles that demand new, specialized skills. Although digitally savvy youth can seize these opportunities, many lack access to the training needed to thrive in these emerging fields.

Geographic disparities further influence unemployment rates. In some regions, job opportunities are scarce, yet many young people cannot afford to relocate to major urban centers. This mismatch contributes to uneven youth unemployment across different areas.

Possible Solutions

A variety of strategies can help reduce youth unemployment. First, greater emphasis should be placed on vocational and technical education. After high school, young people should be guided not only toward universities but also into career-oriented training programs tailored to labor-market demands. This approach enables them to secure employment more quickly and build a strong foundation for their careers.

Second, internship and apprenticeship programs for youth must be expanded. Collaborations between public agencies and private-sector employers can provide young people with valuable work experience and networking opportunities. To ensure participation, these programs should offer stipends or wages within the financial reach of young participants.

Encouraging entrepreneurship among young people is another key solution. Aspiring young entrepreneurs can be supported through government-backed funding, mentorship schemes, and incubator centers—empowering them to launch their own businesses and, in turn, create jobs for others.

Finally, career counseling services, job placement centers, and online learning platforms should be widely promoted to guide young people in developing in-demand skills.

Conclusion

Youth unemployment is a structural problem that affects not only individuals but also society's overall well-being. When young people's participation in the workforce increases, economic growth is bolstered, social cohesion strengthens, and collective optimism rises. Therefore, solutions to youth unemployment in the United States must be holistic, sustainable, and inclusive. By thoughtfully designing education, experience-building, guidance, and support mechanisms, we can enable young people to realize their full potential and become productive members of society.

Karditsa: A Greek City

by *Billy Kakousios (7A)*

Karditsa is a vibrant city located in western Thessaly, Greece, serving as the capital of the Karditsa regional unit. With a population of approximately 56,000 as of 2021, it is renowned for its rich history, cultural heritage, and commitment to sustainable living.

Karditsa is celebrated for its extensive network of bicycle paths, making it one of the most bicycle-friendly cities in Greece. Approximately 30% of all city transportation is conducted by bicycles, reflecting the city's dedication to eco-friendly initiatives.



Continued: *Karditsa: A Greek City*

A short drive from the city lies Lake Plastira, a stunning artificial lake surrounded by picturesque villages and lush forests. The area offers opportunities for hiking, kayaking, and horseback riding, making it a popular destination for nature enthusiasts.

The history of **Karditsa**, Greece, is rich and spans thousands of years, with roots in **prehistoric times** and a strong legacy through the **Byzantine**, **Ottoman**, and **modern eras**.

Ancient & Prehistoric Times

- **Neolithic settlements** dating back to **9000 BC** have been found in the region, making Karditsa one of the oldest continuously inhabited areas in Europe.
- The area was part of **ancient Thessaly**, a fertile and strategically important region in central Greece.
- Nearby cities like **Gomfoi** and **Metropolis** flourished in classical antiquity.

Byzantine & Medieval Period

- During the **Byzantine Empire**, the region was largely agricultural but also served as a defensive frontier.
- Local villages and monasteries were built, and the Orthodox Christian tradition took deep root.

Ottoman Rule (15th century – 1881)

- Karditsa, like much of Thessaly, was conquered by the **Ottoman Empire** in the 15th century.
- The city developed as a **small rural center**, with a mixed population of Christians and Muslims.
- Agriculture, particularly tobacco and cotton, became central to the economy.

Liberation & Modern Greek State (1881)

- Karditsa became part of the modern Greek state in **1881**, following the Treaty of Berlin.
- It began to modernize slowly, with improvements in transportation and education.

World War II and Resistance

- Karditsa holds a **notable place in WWII history**: it became the **first free city in occupied Europe** in **March 1943**, after the Italian army withdrew and local partisans took control.
- The region was active in the **Greek Resistance**, with strong guerrilla presence in the nearby mountains.

The Rise of Artificial Intelligence

by *Leyla Mammadzade (9A)*

Imagine a world where your phone knows what you want before you even ask, your fridge can order groceries for you, and cars drive themselves. Sounds like science fiction, right? Not anymore. Artificial Intelligence (AI) is no longer a futuristic dream—it's already a big part of our daily lives. From voice assistants to smart apps, AI is quietly changing the way we live, work, and learn.

AI is becoming more common in schools too. Some apps use AI to create personalized learning paths for students based on their performance. Teachers use tools that can grade multiple-choice tests instantly or suggest improvements in student writing. Translation apps help students learn new languages or communicate with classmates from different cultures.



Continued: *The Rise of Artificial Intelligence*

AI can make life easier and more efficient. It helps people save time, stay organized, and solve problems quickly. In healthcare, AI can even help doctors detect diseases early. For students, it can be a powerful tool for research, homework help, and staying on track. Despite its advantages, AI also raises concerns. Some people worry that machines could take over human jobs. Others are concerned about privacy, as AI systems often collect and use personal data. That's why it's important to use AI responsibly and understand its limits.

Artificial Intelligence is no longer just a futuristic idea—it's a powerful tool that is already shaping our world. From helping us learn better to making daily tasks easier, AI is becoming an essential part of life. But as we enjoy its benefits, we must also think about how to use it wisely and protect our privacy. The future with AI looks exciting, and today's young generation will play a big role in deciding how it grows.

Women's Rights in Turkey: Before and After Atatürk

by *Öykü Çetin (10A)*

Under the Ottoman Empire, women's rights were quite limited. Social, economic, and political rights for women were restricted and largely shaped by traditional Sharia law. Key points from that era include:

1. Legal Status and Civil Rights

- Because the legal system was based on Sharia, women did have inheritance rights but received smaller shares compared to men.
- Women could serve as witnesses in court, but their testimony carried less weight than that of men.
- Divorce rights favored men: while men could divorce unilaterally, women had to meet specific conditions to obtain a divorce.
- Polygamy was legal, allowing men to marry multiple women.

2. Education and Employment

- Early in Ottoman history, women's access to education was very limited. By the late 19th century, however, some girls' schools began to open.
- In **1858**, the first girls' "rüştiye" (middle schools) were established.
- In **1913**, the İnas Darülfünun (women's higher learning school) opened as the first teacher-training institution for women.
- It was only in **1914** that women were admitted to universities.
- Women's participation in the workforce remained narrow—largely confined to domestic work, agriculture, and traditional handicrafts—though by the late Ottoman period, nursing and teaching began to open up as professions for women.

3. Political and Public Life

- Women had no political rights: they could neither vote nor run for office, nor participate in formal political activities.
- They could engage in charitable and foundation work but otherwise had very limited roles in public life.
- In the empire's final years, several women's rights associations formed, most notably the Ottoman Defense of Women's Rights Society (Osmanlı Müdafaa-i Hukuk-ı Nisvan Cemiyeti) in **1913**.



Continued: Women's Rights in Turkey: Before and After Atatürk

Under the leadership of Gazi Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, the Republic of Turkey enacted sweeping reforms that elevated women's rights to a modern standard. Major developments include:

1. Legal and Civil Rights

- 1926 – Adoption of the Turkish Civil Code
 - ◊ Replaced Sharia-based Ottoman family law.
 - ◊ Instituted monogamy and banned polygamy.
 - ◊ Granted women the right to divorce on equal terms with men.
 - ◊ Established full gender equality in inheritance law.
 - ◊ Equalized women's right to testify in court.

2. Education and Employment

- Coeducation was introduced, and girls' schooling was actively promoted.
- Women gained access to all levels of higher education.
- Female professionals began to work as doctors, teachers, engineers, and lawyers.
- By the 1930s, women could enter public service and hold civil-service positions.

3. Political Rights: Voting and Candidacy

- **1930 – Municipal Elections:** Women received the right to vote and run for office in local (municipal) elections.
- **1933 – Village Headman (Muhtar) Elections:** Women were granted the right to vote and be elected as village headmen and council members.
- **1934 – Parliamentary Elections:** Turkish women gained full suffrage, including the right to stand for national parliament. In the **1935** elections, 18 women were elected to the Grand National Assembly—among the earliest in Europe to do so.

4. Social Role and Modernization

- Atatürk encouraged women's active participation in social life.
- Women made visible contributions in sports, the arts, science, and literature.
- The **1925 Dress Reform** abolished compulsory veiling, allowing women to adopt modern attire.

Thanks to Atatürk's reforms, Turkish women achieved significant gains in civil rights, political representation, education, and employment. While challenges remain, the foundations laid during his leadership propelled Turkey toward contemporary standards of gender equality.

Gambling Addiction and Its Social Impacts

by Aden Güler (7A)

Everyone knows how harmful gambling is. But most people do not know how harmful it is. Today I will tell you how harmful it is.

What is Gambling and Casino?

First, let's start with a question. What is gambling and casino? Gambling is a game in which people bet money and play with luck. Although its date is unknown, the oldest recorded gambling game is Chinese with a history of 2300 years. However, it is estimated that it was used for entertainment and fortune telling in the past. Gambling can be played in casinos, but today it can also be played on the internet.



Continued: *Gambling Addiction and Its Social Impacts*

Casinos are where gambling games are played. There are all kinds of games of chance in casinos. But I decided to give you only the common ones.

Common gambling games:

Joint betting, Online gambling, Card game, Blackjack, Roulette, Crap, Betting, Backgammon, Dominoes, Okey, Number lotto, Lottery, Scratchcard, Horse racing, and Poker.

What are the harms of gambling?

There are many harms of gambling, but I want to talk about 4 of them.

- 1. Increased Risk of Addiction:** Playing in a group can cause a person to normalize gambling and lose more money.
- 2. Financial Losses:** Gambling is based on losing rather than the possibility of winning. When playing together, more money can be spent with the feeling that “luck will turn”.
- 3. Can Damage Social Relationships:** Gambling can cause disagreements between friends or family members.
- 4. Legal and Moral Issues:** Gambling is subject to strict regulations in many countries, and illegal betting can have serious consequences.

Healthier Alternatives

There are many things you can do instead of gambling.

- 1. Doing sports:** Walking, doing martial arts, etc. makes people feel good and keeps them away from gambling
- 2. Fun games:** Instead of gambling, you can play games, read books, or draw pictures etc.
- 3. Financial investment:** You can buy and sell funds and make bitcoins to invest in your future.

New Exhibitions Across Turkey

by İrem Geyik (9A)

This spring, exhibitions across Turkey showcase diverse art and culture. Merve Atılğan’s *Other Side of the Universe* at x-ist, *Tradition and Modernity* at Arkas Art Center, and *Samih Rifat: So Much to Do* at Pera Museum offer a glimpse into Turkey’s evolving artistic landscape.

New Exhibition at x-ist: “Other Side of the Universe”

Merve Atılğan’s first solo show, *Other Side of the Universe*, opens at x-ist. In this exhibition, the artist asks whether we can break the cycle of the oppressive, patriarchal system that has governed us for centuries and build in its place a free and egalitarian utopia. Through works that invite viewers to explore their own primal nature, awaken suppressed intuitions, and imagine alternative modes of being beyond the limits imposed by patriarchy, Atılğan reminds us that a world in which every being is equal and free is indeed possible.

- **Date:** April 10 – May 10, 2025
- **Venue:** x-ist, Gümüşsuyu / Beyoğlu
- **Entry Information:** x-ist



Continued: *New Exhibitions Across Turkey*

Tradition and Modernity: Turkish Painting in the Arkas Collection (1920–1970)

Arkas Art Center presents Tradition and Modernity: Turkish Painting in the Arkas Collection (1920–1970), an exhibition that sheds light on the modernization of Turkish painting. Featuring over 110 works drawn from the Arkas Collection, it showcases how artists navigated the balance between tradition and modernity during the transition from the Ottoman era to the Republic. At the same time, the show offers a preview of the upcoming Arkas Art Göztepe collection. Together, these two exhibitions trace the development of Turkish painting for audiences to explore.

- **Date:** March 26 – December 28, 2025
- **Venue:** Arkas Art Center, İzmir
- **Entry Information:** Arkas Art Center

Samih Rifat's Intellectual Legacy at Pera Museum

To mark its 20th anniversary, the Suna and İnan Kıraç Foundation's Pera Museum presents Samih Rifat: "So Much to Do", the first comprehensive exhibition to open a window onto the artistic and intellectual universe of one of the cultural world's great polymaths. Featuring Samih Rifat's photographs alongside his notebooks, handwritten notes, poems, translations, sketches, writings, films, and musical compositions, the show reveals his interdisciplinary journey and poetic sensibility. Curated and designed by Bülent Erkmén—with Serhan Ada as scholarly consultant and Esra Özdoğan and Ahmet Elhan as photography consultants—the exhibition brings Rifat's intellectual heritage into full view.

- **Date:** March 20 – August 17, 2025
 - **Venue:** Pera Museum, Istanbul
 - **Entry Information:** Pera Museum
-

Most Popular Games (2024-2025)

by *Melis Seyhan (9A)*

1. Garena Free Fire

- Daily Active Users: Approximately 150 million.
- Popular Regions: Southeast Asia and South America.
- Why Popular: Appeals to a wide audience thanks to its low hardware requirements.

2. Roblox

- Monthly Active Users: Over 200 million.
- Features: A platform where users can create their own games.
- Popular Age Group: Extremely popular among younger players.

3. Minecraft

- Total Sales: 350 million copies, making it the best-selling game of all time.
- YouTube Views: 1.5 trillion views as of 2024.
- Features: A sandbox structure that fosters creativity.

4. Grand Theft Auto V (GTA V)

- Twitch Watch Time (2024): 1.4 billion hours, the most-watched game.
- Sales Figures: 210 million copies.
- Why Popular: Continually updated content and role-playing servers via GTA Online.



Continued: *Most Popular Games (2024-2025)*

5. League of Legends

- Twitch Watch Time (2024): 1.19 billion hours.
- Features: A competitive MOBA structure and a vast player base fueled by e-sports events.

Top Revenue-Generating Games

1. Dungeon Fighter Online

- Total Revenue: \$22 billion.
- Popular Regions: Especially strong in Asia.
- Features: A 2D beat 'em up style with a microtransaction revenue model.

2. Space Invaders

- Total Revenue (Inflation-Adjusted): Approximately \$30 billion.
- Features: This 1978 arcade classic is one of the pioneers of the video game industry.

3. Fortnite

- Total Revenue: Over \$10 billion.
- Features: Generates massive income through its battle royale mode and in-game purchases.

4. Honor of Kings

- Total Revenue: Over \$10 billion.
- Popular Regions: Boasts a huge player base in Asia, particularly China.

5. PUBG: Battlegrounds

- Total Sales: 75 million copies.
- Features: One of the pioneers of the battle royale genre, achieving success through both sales and in-game revenue.

April 23rd: Celebrating Sovereignty and the Future of Children

by *Fatih Selçuk*

Introduction

April 23, 1920, is not only the day the Grand National Assembly of Turkey was inaugurated, but also the date on which the Turkish nation formally and permanently declared its sovereignty. Mustafa Kemal Atatürk's decision to dedicate this day as the "Children's Day" reveals both his understanding of sovereignty and his vision for the future. April 23rd is one of the cornerstones of modern Turkey, due to its historical significance, political message, and social function.

Historical Background

Following the Armistice of Mudros, the Ottoman Empire effectively came to an end, and the country was placed under occupation. After the dissolution of the Ottoman Parliament (Meclis-i Mebusan) in Istanbul, Mustafa Kemal Pasha proposed the establishment of a new assembly to represent the national will. The Turkish Grand National Assembly (TGNA), opened in Ankara on April 23, 1920, was not merely a legislative body—it was the command center of the national struggle. With its establishment, sovereignty was transferred from the sultan to the people, marking the beginning of a governance model based on national sovereignty.



Continued: April 23rd: Celebrating Sovereignty and the Future of Children

Atatürk's Value for Children

Mustafa Kemal Atatürk did not proclaim April 23rd solely as a political turning point; he also gifted it to children as their holiday. This decision clearly reflects his belief that sovereignty belongs to the generations that will shape the future. According to Atatürk, children are the guarantors of the republic's continuity and the future of democracy. Therefore, April 23rd celebrations are centered on children, who on this day symbolically assume roles as leaders and decision-makers in society.

National and Universal Dimensions

While April 23rd is a national holiday in Turkey, it also holds the unique distinction of being the first and only holiday in the world dedicated specifically to children. Long before UNESCO promoted children's rights globally, Atatürk's initiative demonstrated Turkey's commitment to universal human values. Today, with international child delegations participating in festivities, the celebrations have acquired a global dimension, reflecting Turkey's desire to universalize the spirit of the holiday.

Conclusion

April 23rd National Sovereignty and Children's Day marks the culmination of the Turkish nation's struggle for independence and liberty. It institutionalizes popular sovereignty and symbolizes the trust and love placed in children as the architects of the future. More than just a commemoration of the past, this holiday is a living, annual reaffirmation of the belief that democracy, freedom, and peace will be carried forward by the hands of children. Therefore, April 23rd is not only a holiday but also a day of ongoing national renewal in collective memory.

***Thank you for reading
and supporting the ICS
Journalism Club.***

Writers:

- Bora Yağız (8A)
- Meiling Kamilova (10A)
- Yağız Erdoğan (6A)
- S. Aeera Fetima (7A)
- İdil Kalyencioğlu (10A)
- Billy Kakousios (7A)
- Leyla Mammadzade (9A)
- Öykü Çetin (10A)

- Aden Güler (7A)
- İrem Geyik (9A)
- Melis Seyhan (9A)
- Fatih Selçuk

Editors:

- Fatih Selçuk
- Samyar Sadat Akhavi

Page Layout:

- Samyar Sadat Akhavi

Coordination:

- Fatih Selçuk

Prepared by:

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